Manual for uploading excel sheets to the centralized CGG meta data database.

The intention for this manual is to guide the user in uploading as well as to introduce them to the processing, parsing, and formatting of their meta data.

Contents

Step-by-step guide to uploading:

1. Go to dandyweb01fl.unicph.domain/upload_excel in you web browser of choice (Google Chrome is probably best, but others should work fine). This is the site you will use to upload your tabular/spreadsheet meta data to the tables in a database.
   However, the database tables have a fixed number of columns, and the columns have specific names and datatypes. The spreadsheet you upload needs to match this. To help you with this, I've made a list of Excel sheet examples and templates that you will see on the website (the list of blue hyperlinks). Download the one that is relevant for you. If you don't know which ones are, feel free to ask the admin. To make it easy for you, the example/template sheets are made such that they correspond to sheets you are already using, so there should be no need to change your own templates. If this is not the case, and you need the database templates to be edited, feel free to contact admin.

2. Locate the sheet you want to upload and open it.

3. Save the sheet as "Unicode Text (.txt)" (windows) or "UTF-16 unicode text" (mac). Note: This will only save the active sheet, and not the whole Excel file, so make sure you are saving the correct sheet that you want to upload.

4. Go back to dandyweb01fl.unicph.domain/upload_excel, click the "Choose File" button and choose the .txt file you just saved.

5. Select the spreadsheet type (corresponds to the template links above).

6. Select the formatting options that are applicable to your sheet.

7. Press upload.

8. Your data will be parsed, meaning, dates and decimal points will be converted to the database standard (YYYY-MM-DD and ".") (see details below). If the formatting of your data corresponds to the format options you chose, the parsed data will be displayed as a table. Review the data to make sure it is correct, and press confirm if it is.

9. When you press confirm, your data will be uploaded to the database and redirected to a page that shows you exactly how the data looks in the database. Double check that the data looks okay.

Standard Excel format requirements/recommendations:

The following is what I found to work best with the database, without making any unnecessary extra work for you. Right now, the database is pretty flexible in terms of format, but in the future, it will be more rigid. So, I suggest you try to comply with the recommended formatting suggested below pointing forward, to prevent any tedious data cleanup. I indicate if the format is required or recommended (future requirement).

Empty cells (requirement)

Leave cells empty if there is no data to put there. Do not write "N/A" or "-" or anything. Just leave it empty.

Intervals (requirement)

Intervals should be in a restricted mathematical notation and only the following characters are allowed: “[“ “)” “,” and numbers (no decimal allowed, unless you use “.” as decimal point). This means that [1, 2) is allowed but not (1, 2), (1, 2] or [1, 2]. This is unfortunately a standard the database follows that is difficult to change. If this is very difficult for you to comply with, contact the admin and we might be able to figure out something.

Decimal points (recommendation)

The following is the safest and best approach for the database, as this is the standard of the database and therefore does not require error prone parsing:

Decimal point = "."

Thousand separators = "," or no separator (preferably the latter).

You can still upload other formats but try to change to this format pointing forward, as it has better compatibility with the database.

Primary ids (requirement)

Primary IDs must not be null. Remove rows that do not have a primary ID before uploading, or you will get an error. Primary IDs are defined as an identifier that uniquely identifies a row of the spreadsheet (archive sample ID, robot sample ID, library ID etc.). We might include an option to input exactly which rows you want to upload in the future if this will make it easier for you.

Multiple values in one cell (recommendation)

If a column contains multiple values, separate them with semicolon. For example, if a sample was taken by multiple people the 'Sampled By' column input should be "Alice; Bob".

Personal identifiers (recommendation)

Internal: KU ids, as they are guaranteed to be unique, and can be used to look up relevant information.

External: Use email

Details on formatting and parsing:

When choosing a format from the dropdowns, any column will be validated against this format and the data will only be uploaded if it conforms to this format.

All data will first be parsed as strings and if the format looks ok, it will be transformed to dates, floating point numbers, integers, ranges etc.

IMPORTANT: Be careful when choosing decimal point and thousand separator formats. If you choose wrong, there is no way for the parser to know, and it will parse your data incorrectly. For example, if you have a small measurement of 1,9 and choose “.” as thousands separator the data will be interpreted as 1900 and not 1 point 9.

Admin contact info

Contact magnus.johannsen@sund.ku.dk if you encounter any errors you cannot resolve, or if you have any questions.